to be protected against abductions and 'disappearances' by the security state; 'dignity' of existence (this refers especially to dehumanizing treatment at security checkpoints); de-mining of their homes and villages; and the establishment of a Truth and Reconciliation Commission to provide justice to families whose loved ones have been 'picked up' or killed in military operations. Manzoor Pashteen, the twenty-five-year-old leader of the movement, has repeatedly cited the constitution when making these demands, clearly providing an opportunity for the state to demonstrate its commitment to its citizens. The movement has been critical of the military's role in promoting a culture of racial profiling and violating the rights of Pashtuns as Pakistani citizens. However, far from engaging with this movement, the response of the security state has been one of censorship and intimidation, with supporters being harassed and picked up by security personnel, with Pashteen being denied the right to freely move around in Pakistan to travel to his rallies. Policies such as NCEPG 2018 clearly illustrate that the state is aware of the weaknesses of state–citizen relations (albeit through a security lens), where its failure to respond to a peaceful movement demanding rights under the constitution is all the more revealing of the nature of the security state that will only allow narratives of national identity and belonging that are defined within its security contract with its Pakistani subjects.

## Notes

1 Translation: '*We will not do anything for children who are dying in Thar, but for a cricket match we will even burn things.*'
2 This focus group included participants from Lahore, Kasur, Kanganpur, Dera Ghazi Khan, Rajanpur and Rawalpindi.
3 The Thar desert is a drought prone area but has particularly witnessed worsening conditions since 2013 (https://reliefweb.int/report/pakistan/pakistan-life-grip-drought-thar-desert).
4 See for example the water racket in Karachi that keeps residents without water for weeks at a time (Hashim 2017b).
5 A reduction of the state is not unusual as globalization has changed the functions of the state from provider to regulator across the developed world. Aid politics and policy borrowing have brought the neoliberal model to Pakistan. Today neoliberal theory literature looks less at citizens and more at consumers, and when it comes to rights it more often than not tends to operate on the basis of choice rather than rights. However, we do not argue here that Pakistan has chosen a neoliberal path